Simple Business English

# Project Status Update: як звітувати про дедлайни, затримки та ризики англійською

**Ситуація:** Tariq, a project manager at a health-snack FMCG company, meets with Fiona, the marketing director, in her office for their monthly new product launch review.
**Tariq** — Project Manager for New Product Introductions · **Fiona** — Marketing Director

## Транскрипт

**Fiona:** Good morning, Tariq. Good to see you. Ready for our monthly project status meeting?

**Tariq:** Good morning, Fiona. Yes, absolutely. I prepared all the latest updates across our operational streams.

**Fiona:** Perfect. Our national launch is still planned for early September, correct?

**Tariq:** That is correct. We have ten weeks left on the master calendar before launch day.

**Fiona:** Excellent. Take me through the key areas so we can spot any pressing issues.

**Tariq: Here is a quick overview of** where things stand right now across the project.

**Fiona:** Good. How are you structuring the project blocks for our discussion today?

**Tariq:** I split everything into three clear categories: on track, behind, and at risk.

**Fiona:** That is a very practical structure. Let us start with the good news first.

**Tariq:** Regarding product development, the final recipe is fully approved and signed off.

**Fiona:** Wonderful news. Did the consumer taste tests meet our initial benchmark targets?

**Tariq:** Yes, eighty-two percent of blind testers preferred our bar over the market leader.

**Fiona:** That is an impressive score. What about the packaging artwork?

**Tariq:** The packaging design is completely finalized and already sent to the print supplier.

**Fiona:** Did internal legal counsel approve all nutritional claims on the front label?

**Tariq:** Yes, legal cleared all wording, including our twenty-gram high-protein message and sugar-free badge.

**Fiona:** That is a great relief. How are things looking on the manufacturing side?

**Tariq: Everything is running on schedule.** Our operations team has done great work preparing the lines.

**Fiona:** Have all the raw ingredients arrived safely at our factory warehouse?

**Tariq:** Yes, the bulk protein powder and natural flavors arrived without any issues.

**Fiona:** That is good to hear. When is our industrial pilot test scheduled to take place?

**Tariq:** The pilot production run is set for next Tuesday morning at nine o'clock.

**Fiona:** Will someone from quality assurance supervise the entire manufacturing process?

**Tariq:** Yes, our quality manager will be on the plant floor throughout the run.

**Fiona:** Great. If the pilot passes, when does commercial production begin?

**Tariq:** Full-scale commercial production starts on the first Monday of August.

**Fiona:** So operational supply chain and product formulation are completely on track.

**Tariq:** Exactly. We see zero operational delays in the production pipeline.

**Fiona:** Good. Now let us examine the yellow block. What is falling behind?

**Tariq: We are currently running behind on** our commercial retail listings with two major supermarket chains.

**Fiona:** That surprises me. I thought key accounts started talks six weeks ago.

**Tariq:** They started on time, but contract negotiations have stalled with two key partners.

**Fiona:** Which specific retail accounts are we talking about here?

**Tariq:** MegaMart and PrimeStore. Both accounts delayed signing their listing agreements with us.

**Fiona: What is causing the delay?** Did their category managers give us a specific reason?

**Tariq:** MegaMart postponed their annual snack category review by three full weeks due to restructuring.

**Fiona:** That is frustrating. Did they replace the previous category manager during this change?

**Tariq:** Yes, a new category buyer took over last week and restarted all evaluations.

**Fiona:** I understand how that delays things. What is the story with PrimeStore then?

**Tariq:** PrimeStore is demanding a twenty-five percent higher listing fee for eye-level placement.

**Fiona:** Twenty-five percent is excessive. That goes way beyond our agreed commercial launch budget.

**Tariq:** Our sales representative pushed back firmly, but their commercial team refuses to move.

**Fiona:** How much time have we lost on the retail track because of this?

**Tariq:** We are currently three weeks behind our target timeline for retail agreements.

**Fiona:** That is a serious concern. MegaMart and PrimeStore represent huge market share.

**Tariq: This puts our launch date at risk.** We cannot hit our target without them.

**Fiona:** Combined, those two chains represent nearly forty percent of our projected sales volume.

**Tariq:** That is why this delay threatens our total revenue target for fourth quarter.

**Fiona:** We definitely cannot afford to postpone our national launch until winter.

**Tariq: How much time do we have left?** When is our absolute cutoff date for listings?

**Fiona:** To lock in September distribution, we have two weeks maximum to finalize terms.

**Tariq:** If we miss that window, warehouse logistics cannot schedule initial store shipments.

**Fiona:** Then standard negotiations will not work. We need executive escalation for MegaMart immediately.

**Tariq:** Do you have a direct connection with their senior commercial management team?

**Fiona:** Yes, Arthur Cole, their new commercial director, was my colleague at my old company.

**Tariq: Could you step in and** speak with Arthur directly to speed up the process?

**Fiona:** Yes, I can contact Arthur personally and request an urgent call tomorrow.

**Tariq:** That would help us bypass the buyer backlog and secure our review slot.

**Fiona:** Please prepare a concise briefing document with product data before five today.

**Tariq:** I will draft that executive summary now and email it this afternoon.

**Fiona:** Excellent. What is our action plan for resolving the dispute with PrimeStore?

**Tariq:** Simon from our key account team is leading those commercial discussions right now.

**Fiona: I will follow up with** Simon right after lunch to review our counter-offer options together.

**Tariq:** Perhaps we could offer co-marketing promotions instead of paying a higher cash fee.

**Fiona:** That makes commercial sense. Retail buyers often accept joint promotional funding over upfront fees.

**Tariq:** That brings us directly to our third block: the item marked at risk.

**Fiona:** Right. You flagged an issue regarding our marketing launch budget.

**Tariq:** Exactly. Finance is reviewing third-quarter operating expenses across all departments.

**Fiona:** Are they trying to trim commercial budgets for upcoming product launches?

**Tariq:** Yes, finance proposed an across-the-board fifteen percent cut to our trade marketing budget.

**Fiona:** A fifteen percent cut would severely damage our in-store tasting and influencer campaigns.

**Tariq:** In-store sampling is our main tool to get consumers to try our new bar.

**Fiona: We need to protect our** promotional launch budget so the product gains immediate traction.

**Tariq:** Can you defend our original budget allocation during tomorrow's executive leadership meeting?

**Fiona:** I definitely will. I will present a strong commercial case supported by solid data.

**Tariq:** I can provide updated sales projection figures to strengthen your presentation slides today.

**Fiona:** That would be very useful. Include preliminary orders from regional retail chains too.

**Tariq:** We already confirmed advance orders from more than eighty independent supermarket locations nationwide.

**Fiona:** That is strong evidence. Finance executives respond well to confirmed customer pre-orders.

**Tariq:** I will incorporate those confirmed retailer numbers into your slide deck by two o'clock.

**Fiona:** Thank you, Tariq. Let us quickly summarize our main decisions and next steps.

**Tariq:** First, you will call Arthur Cole at MegaMart tomorrow to resolve the listing delay.

**Fiona:** Right. And I will meet with Simon today to discuss our counter-proposal for PrimeStore.

**Tariq:** Second, I will deliver the executive briefing sheet and financial slides this afternoon.

**Fiona:** Third, you will travel to the plant next Tuesday to oversee the pilot run.

**Tariq:** Yes, I will oversee the trial run personally and report the results.

**Fiona:** Are there any other potential bottlenecks or dependencies that could affect our timeline?

**Tariq:** No, all other components, including digital assets and logistics, are moving forward smoothly.

**Fiona:** Good. If we execute these corrective steps quickly, we will recover our lost time.

**Tariq:** I agree completely. Our team is committed to delivering the September launch.

**Fiona:** Thank you for your honest status reporting, Tariq. Transparency makes problem-solving much easier.

**Tariq:** It is my pleasure. Early visibility helps us fix issues before they grow.

**Fiona: Let's touch base again in** two weeks to review our progress on these action items.

**Tariq:** That works well for me. I will send a calendar invitation right away.

**Fiona:** Great. Thank you, Tariq. Have a productive rest of your day.

**Tariq:** Thank you, Fiona. Good luck with Arthur and the board meeting tomorrow.

## Ключові фрази випуску

| | |
|---|---|
| **Here is a quick overview of** | introducing a brief summary of a situation<br>— Here is a quick overview of our quarterly sales performance.<br>— Here is a quick overview of the client's main requirements. |
| **Everything is running on schedule.** | all tasks are progressing at the expected time<br>— Everything is running on schedule for our branch opening.<br>— You do not need to worry, everything is running on schedule. |
| **We are currently running behind on** | delayed in completing a specific task or deliverable<br>— We are currently running behind on supplier contracts.<br>— The team is currently running behind on software testing. |
| **What is causing the delay?** | asking why something is taking longer than planned<br>— What is causing the delay with customs clearance?<br>— Can you explain what is causing the delay on this report? |
| **This puts our launch date at risk.** | this issue may cause us to miss our deadline<br>— Packaging delays put our launch date at risk.<br>— If they refuse, this puts our launch date at risk. |
| **How much time do we have left?** | asking about remaining available time before a deadline<br>— How much time do we have left before store deliveries begin?<br>— How much time do we have left to accept their offer? |
| **Could you step in and** | politely requesting a manager or colleague to intervene<br>— Could you step in and speak with their procurement director?<br>— Could you step in and approve this budget exception? |
| **I will follow up with** | promising to contact someone or check on progress<br>— I will follow up with the warehouse team this afternoon.<br>— I will follow up with our distributor tomorrow morning. |
| **We need to protect our** | emphasizing that an important resource must not be lost<br>— We need to protect our profit margins during inflation.<br>— We need to protect our core team during this reorganization. |
| **Let's touch base again in** | suggesting a short follow-up meeting after a specific period<br>— Let's touch base again in a couple of days.<br>— Let's touch base again in one week to review numbers. |

## Типові помилки

✗ Помилка: ~~We are behind the schedule by three weeks.~~
✓ Краще: **We are behind schedule by three weeks.**
The business idiom is 'behind schedule', used without the definite article 'the'.

✗ Помилка: ~~We are late on three weeks with our retail agreements.~~
✓ Краще: **We are three weeks late with our retail agreements.**
In English, state the time duration directly before 'late', not after with 'on'.

✗ Помилка: ~~We discussed about the trade marketing budget this morning.~~
✓ Краще: **We discussed the trade marketing budget this morning.**
The verb 'discuss' takes a direct object without the preposition 'about'.

✗ Помилка: ~~The final result depends from the decision of retail buyers.~~
✓ Краще: **The final result depends on the decision of retail buyers.**
Use 'depend on', not 'depend from' (a common native language calque).

✗ Помилка: ~~I will call the commercial director for negotiate better terms.~~
✓ Краще: **I will call the commercial director to negotiate better terms.**
Use 'to + base verb' to express purpose, never 'for + infinitive'.

## Тест

**1. What is the status of the product recipe and packaging?**
A) Both are completed and fully approved.
B) The recipe needs an additional tasting round.
C) The packaging artwork was rejected by legal.

**2. Why is the listing delayed with MegaMart?**
A) MegaMart rejected the product taste tests.
B) Their category review was delayed by restructuring.
C) The factory failed the initial safety inspection.

**3. What issue arose during negotiations with PrimeStore?**
A) PrimeStore demanded a twenty-five percent higher listing fee.
B) PrimeStore refused to sell protein snacks altogether.
C) PrimeStore demanded exclusive sales rights for one year.

**4. What risk does the finance department create for the launch?**
A) They stopped paying external transport suppliers.
B) They proposed a fifteen percent cut to launch marketing.
C) They delayed the factory pilot run until winter.

**5. How will Fiona help Tariq resolve the MegaMart delay?**
A) She will call their commercial director directly.
B) She will accept all of MegaMart's penalty terms.
C) She will cancel the launch in MegaMart stores.

Відповіді: 1-A 2-B 3-A 4-B 5-A

Голоси в діалогах згенеровані ШІ. Кожен випуск побудований на реальному анонімізованому кейсі з 15+ років досвіду ведучого у FMCG та key account management.